



19 AI SKILLS COMPANIES ARE HIRING FOR RIGHT NOW

The Non-Technical Professional's Guide
to Future-Proofing Your Career in 2026

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INTRODUCTION

HERE'S A NUMBER WORTH PAYING ATTENTION TO.

Pay premium
+28%

Extra per year (US)
+\$18,000

Postings requiring AI
5% → 9%

AI fluency demand
7x a year

Workers with AI skills earn 28% more than peers without them. That's roughly \$18,000 more per year in the US. And job postings requiring AI skills have jumped from 5% to 9% in a single year, with AI fluency growing 7x as a listed requirement.

What's different now is where those requirements are showing up. LinkedIn data shows AI competencies are becoming standard expectations across marketing, HR, operations, and leadership, not just engineering.

This isn't a career guide for developers. It's for non-technical professionals who want to know which specific AI skills employers are paying a premium for, and where to start.

19 skills. Beginner to advanced.

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE



Prompt engineering

What it is	Writing clear instructions to get reliable, repeatable results from AI tools.		
Who's hiring	Marketing	HR	Operations
Level	Beginner Advanced		
Start with	ChatGPT or Claude		

EACH SKILL INCLUDES:

What it is, Who is hiring for it, Beginner vs. Advanced level, and the tool to Start with. You don't need to build all 19. Identify the two or three most relevant to your role and start there. Many of the fastest-growing requirements are accessible to non-technical professionals within weeks.

AI LITERACY AND PROMPT ENGINEERING

Why this category matters:

LinkedIn describes AI literacy and prompt engineering as "**the new baseline.**" A growing share of job postings now expects professionals to be comfortable working with tools like **ChatGPT**, **Claude**, or **Gemini**, across all functions, not just technical roles.

SKILL 1: AI LITERACY



What it is: The ability to understand what AI tools can and cannot do, use them as part of a daily workflow, and explain their outputs to colleagues and stakeholders.



Who is hiring: Virtually every employer. LinkedIn's 2026 data shows AI capabilities moving from "nice-to-have" to standard expectations across marketing, HR, and operations.



Beginner: Can use ChatGPT or Claude to complete basic tasks, drafting emails, summarising documents, researching questions.



Advanced: Recommends the right AI tool for each job and critically assesses output reliability before acting on it.



Tool to start: Claude or ChatGPT. Begin by replacing one manual task per day with an AI-assisted version.

SKILL 2: PROMPT ENGINEERING



What it is: Designing structured instructions that produce useful, specific AI outputs instead of just typing questions and hoping.



Who is hiring: Marketing, HR, operations, and product roles. Average prompt engineering salary (US): \$99,474 per year.



Beginner: Can write a prompt that includes role, context, and format instructions. Gets consistently better outputs than generic questions.



Advanced: Designs prompt libraries and templates for team use. Evaluates and iterates prompt quality systematically. Trains teammates on prompting best practices.



Tool to start: The AI Report's Executive Prompt Library. Study the structure of each prompt, role, context, task, format, before writing your own.

SKILL 3: AI OUTPUT VERIFICATION



What it is: Critically evaluating AI output for accuracy, fabricated citations, and factual errors before acting on it.



Who is hiring: Research, legal, finance, and communications functions.



Beginner: Knows not to share AI output without reading it. Checks factual claims against primary sources.



Advanced: Runs systematic verification processes, cross-referencing across models, checking citations, testing outputs for internal consistency before acting on them.



Tool to start: Perplexity. Because every answer cites sources, it forces source-checking as a habit.

AI WORKFLOW AUTOMATION

Why this category matters:

No-code and low-code AI automation is the fastest-growing non-technical AI skill in the market. Employers want professionals who can build workflows, not just describe them.

SKILL 4: NO-CODE AI WORKFLOW BUILDING



What it is: Using tools like Zapier, Make, or Gumloop to connect applications and automate repetitive tasks without writing code.



Who is hiring: Operations, marketing, HR, and sales functions.



Beginner: Builds a basic Zapier workflow connecting two applications.



Advanced: Designs multi-step automation sequences with conditional logic, error handling, and AI-processing nodes built in.



Tool to start: Zapier. Begin with one automation connecting two tools you already use. Identify a manual task that happens more than five times per week.

SKILL 5: AI-POWERED PROCESS DOCUMENTATION



What it is: Using AI to document and improve business processes faster and more consistently.



Who is hiring: Operations managers, project leads, and business analysts. Any role responsible for how work gets done.



Beginner: Uses AI to convert a verbal process description into a written SOP. Saves documentation time significantly.



Advanced: Builds process documentation frameworks using AI prompts, and audits existing processes for automation candidates.



Tool to start: Claude. The Executive Prompt Library Prompt #47 (Workflow Redesign Brief) is the starting point.

SKILL 6: AI AGENT COORDINATION



What it is: Setting up and managing AI agents, autonomous tools that can perform tasks like web research, data collection, and content processing without continuous human input.



Who is hiring: Operations, marketing, and technology functions.



Beginner: Can run a simple AI agent task, web scraping, data collection, using existing tools.



Advanced: Coordinates multi-agent workflows with human review at defined checkpoints.



Tool to start: Gumloop or Make with AI nodes. Start with a single-agent research task before building multi-agent sequences.

AI CONTENT AND COMMUNICATIONS

Why this category matters:

AI has not replaced content professionals, but it has raised the baseline. Employers now expect content and communications roles to produce more output with the same headcount, which requires AI fluency at the creation stage.

SKILL 7: AI-ASSISTED CONTENT CREATION



What it is: Using AI to produce first drafts, outlines, and content variations, and then editing and improving them using human judgment.



Who is hiring: Marketing, content, and communications roles.



Beginner: Uses AI to produce a first draft of a blog post, email, or social post. Edits to add voice and accuracy.



Advanced: Builds AI-assisted content production workflows, from brief to draft to final, with consistent brand voice and quality checks at each stage.



Tool to start: Claude for long-form. ChatGPT for structured content. Jasper for marketing-specific output with brand voice controls.

SKILL 8: AI VIDEO AND VISUAL CONTENT



What it is: Using AI tools to generate, edit, or enhance visual and video content, reducing production time without reducing output quality.



Who is hiring: Marketing, creative, and social media teams.



Beginner: Can use a text-to-image or image-editing AI tool to produce visual content for presentations or social media.



Advanced: Manages an AI content production pipeline combining text, visual, and video tools at scale.



Tool to start: Gemini for image generation. Gamma for AI presentations.

SKILL 9: AI PRESENTATION AND DOCUMENT PRODUCTION



What it is: Using AI to convert research, data, or rough thinking into structured presentations and documents significantly faster than manual production.



Who is hiring: Strategy, finance, and communications roles producing high-volume presentations.



Beginner: Uses Gamma to generate a first-draft presentation from a prompt or document. Edits and refines.



Advanced: Builds a full AI-assisted presentation workflow from research to final deck.



Tool to start: Gamma. The learning curve is measured in minutes, not hours.

AI-ASSISTED RESEARCH AND ANALYSIS

Why this category matters:

Research and analysis roles are being redefined by AI. The baseline expectation is changing, professionals are expected to cover more ground, find better sources, and synthesize faster.

SKILL 10: AI-POWERED MARKET RESEARCH



What it is: Using AI tools to gather, synthesize, and interpret market data, competitive intelligence, and industry trends faster than traditional research methods.



Who is hiring: Strategy, marketing, and competitive intelligence functions.



Beginner: Uses Perplexity to build a sourced market briefing on a topic. Can cite the sources behind key findings.



Advanced: Runs a weekly competitive intelligence system using Perplexity, Grok, and Claude.



Tool to start: Perplexity. Start with a specific research question in your market and evaluate the output for source quality.

SKILL 11: AI DATA INTERPRETATION



What it is: Using AI to make sense of data sets, reports, and survey results, identifying key patterns, outliers, and actionable implications without requiring data science expertise.



Who is hiring: Operations, marketing, HR, and finance functions.



Beginner: Pastes a dataset or report into Claude and asks for the three most important findings. Verifies the interpretation before sharing.



Advanced: Designs AI-assisted analysis workflows for recurring data reviews with standardised prompts.



Tool to start: Claude with Prompt #84 (Research Synthesis) from the Executive Prompt Library.

SKILL 12: AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE



What it is: Using AI to monitor competitor moves, funding signals, hiring patterns, and market shifts on an ongoing basis, turning passive awareness into active intelligence.



Who is hiring: Strategy, sales, and product functions.



Beginner: Uses Grok or Perplexity to run a weekly competitor scan. Knows what to look for and where.



Advanced: Runs a structured competitive intelligence system, scan, analyze, act, using AI at each stage with documented prompts and output formats.



Tool to start: Grok for real-time signals. Perplexity for sourced research.

AI IN SALES AND REVENUE OPERATIONS

Why this category matters:

Sales and revenue operations is one of the highest-ROI categories for AI adoption. Employers are actively hiring for professionals who can deploy AI tools to improve pipeline, reduce rep workload, and improve forecast accuracy

SKILL 13: AI SALES OUTREACH AND SEQUENCING



What it is: Using AI to personalise outreach at scale, researching prospects, drafting personalised emails and messages, and building sequenced follow-up workflows.



Who is hiring: Sales development and revenue operations at B2B companies.



Beginner: Uses AI to research a prospect and draft a personalised outreach email. Edits and sends.



Advanced: Builds AI-powered outreach sequences with AI handling each stage, not just the first draft.



Tool to start: Perplexity for prospect research. Claude for message drafting. The Executive Prompt Library for structured outreach prompts.

SKILL 14: AI CRM AND PIPELINE MANAGEMENT



What it is: Using AI tools embedded in or connected to CRM systems to update records, surface deal risks, forecast pipeline, and automate follow-up tasks.



Who is hiring: Revenue operations and sales leadership.



Beginner: Uses AI to draft a meeting summary and update CRM fields after a call. Saves time on administrative tasks.



Advanced: Manages an AI-enhanced pipeline review process surfacing deal risks and stalled opportunities.



Tool to start: Fireflies for meeting capture and CRM sync. Gong for sales intelligence if at enterprise scale.

AI IN HUMAN RESOURCES AND TALENT

Why this category matters:

HR is one of the highest-adoption enterprise AI categories. AI is embedded in recruiting, onboarding, performance management, and learning systems. HR professionals who cannot work alongside these tools are at a disadvantage.

SKILL 15: AI-ASSISTED RECRUITING



What it is: Using AI tools to screen applications, draft job descriptions, generate interview questions, and manage candidate communication, without compromising the quality of the hire.



Who is hiring: Talent acquisition and people operations.



Beginner: Uses AI to draft a job description and generate a set of interview questions for a specific role. Edits for accuracy.



Advanced: Manages an AI-assisted recruiting workflow from job brief to structured interview, with humans making final decisions.



Tool to start: Claude with the Executive Prompt Library HR section (Prompts #70-81). Hugging Face's experience: AI-assisted hiring grew their team from 50 to 220 employees with 2+ hours saved per recruiter per week.

SKILL 16: AI PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT



What it is: Using AI to structure performance reviews, prepare development conversations, and build leadership development plans, with more consistency and less preparation time.



Who is hiring: HR business partners and people managers.



Beginner: Uses Claude to structure a performance review conversation using the SBI feedback framework. Gets a consistent, useful structure in minutes.



Advanced: Designs AI-assisted performance management systems any manager can use.



Tool to start: Claude with Prompt #72 (Performance Review Preparation) from the Executive Prompt Library.

SKILL 17: AI LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT



What it is: Using AI to design, personalise, and deliver training content, creating learning experiences faster and more targeted than traditional L&D methods.



Who is hiring: L&D managers and HR leaders.



Beginner: Uses AI to convert an existing training document into a structured learning module with clear objectives and check-in questions.



Advanced: Builds AI-assisted L&D workflows from skills gap identification to content creation.



Tool to start: Claude for content creation. Define the learning objective before prompting, the output quality depends entirely on input specificity.

THREE SKILLS THAT APPLY ACROSS EVERY CATEGORY

SKILL 18: AI ETHICS AND GOVERNANCE AWARENESS



What it is: Understanding where AI can be used appropriately, covering data privacy, bias, and regulatory compliance. This is a professional judgment skill, not a technical one.



Beginner: Knows which data cannot enter external AI tools. Understands the basics of AI bias. **Advanced:** Assesses AI tool suitability, identifies compliance risks, and communicates governance requirements.



Tool to start: The AI Report's Enterprise AI Policy Guide.

SKILL 19: AI TOOL EVALUATION AND SELECTION



What it is: Knowing which AI tool is right for a specific job and being able to justify that decision.



Beginner: Compares two tools for a specific use case on quality, cost, and integration. **Advanced:** Runs formal AI tool evaluation processes with structured criteria and proof-of-concept testing.



Tool to start: This guide. Use it as a framework for your next evaluation decision.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR NEXT MOVE

The professionals who will be most competitive are not the ones who know the most about AI. They are the ones with the most specific, demonstrable AI skills applied to real work. Pick two skills that apply to your current role. Build them. Document what changes. That is your competitive advantage.

THE NATURAL NEXT STEP

The AI Executives Pass is the next level

Get \$14,000+ in AI perks and credits for just \$199/year.
Access premium tools, exclusive resources, and member
benefits built for AI-driven leaders.

